

1. UK — Scotland, Wales & Northern Ireland Seek Separation (“Karma Returns”)

- Leaders of Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland have signed an agreement expressing intent to separate from England and seek independent representation globally.
- **Background:** UK = England + Scotland + Wales + Northern Ireland. Removing Northern Ireland gives **Great Britain** (England + Wales + Scotland).
- **13th century:** King Edward (I) of England annexed Wales; England kept defence & foreign-affairs rights, rest stayed with Wales.
- **1603:** Queen Elizabeth I died without an heir; King James (VI of Scotland) took the English throne — Scotland united with England.
- **1707:** The **Act of Union** combined England + Wales + Scotland into **Great Britain**.
- Ireland later split into Northern Ireland (joined the union) and the Republic of Ireland, forming the present-day **United Kingdom (UK)**.
- Capital of Wales: **Cardiff**. The UK flag is a combination of the flags of its constituent nations (Wales' flag not included).
- If the split is finalised, England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland would each get separate Prime Ministers (currently PM referenced in class: Andy Burnham).
- Map focus: location between the Atlantic Ocean and the North Sea; also note North Sea, Celtic Sea, English Channel and the Strait of Dover.

2. General Knowledge – Recent Exam Questions

- **Father of Carnatic Music:** Purandara Dasa.
- **2024 Paris Olympics:** India won a total of **6 medals** (zero gold).
- **Sultan Azlan Shah Cup & Johor Cup** — both associated with **Hockey**; Johor Cup is held in **Malaysia**.

3. Nuakhai Juhar Festival

- A **harvest festival** linked to agriculture, mainly celebrated in **Western Odisha**, Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand.
- Celebrated on the day after Ganesh Chaturthi — the 5th day of the lunar month (usually August/September).
- Tradition began in the **12th century**, started by **Raja Ramai Deo**.
- Focus crop: **rice/paddy**. "Nua" = new (rice), "Khai" = eat — celebrates eating the season's new rice.
- Term for the new crop: **Nabanna**.
- Believed to originate in **Sambalpur**, Odisha (a region known for its craft/embroidery work).
- Other festivals of Odisha: **Bali Yatra**, **Raja Parba**. Dance performed: **Sambalpuri dance** (not Chhau).

4. Geography Quick Facts

- **Backwaters/Brackish water:** found along the coast of **Kerala**; locally known as **Kayals**.
- **Thar Desert (Rajasthan):** formed because the low-height Aravalli Range fails to block monsoon winds effectively, leading to very low rainfall — India's only true desert.
- **Mars** is gradually losing its atmosphere because the **Sun's magnetic field** pulls away its atmospheric gases.

5. HPV Vaccination Drive (Cervical Cancer Prevention)

- HPV = **Human Papilloma Virus**, the cause of cervical cancer in women.
- Free HPV vaccination was announced in the Union Budget by Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman**.
- Target age group: girls aged **9–14 years**.
- Total doses administered across India so far: approx. **80 lakh**.
- **100% vaccination coverage** (rank order): 1. Gujarat 2. Uttar Pradesh 3. Madhya Pradesh 4. Mizoram.
- **90% coverage:** Bihar. **Highest number of doses used:** Uttar Pradesh (~22 lakh doses).

6–8. Short Current Affairs

- **NASA RECY Mission** — studies **solar flares** (not to be confused with the Parker Solar Probe, which studies the Sun itself).
- **Green Revolution** — linked with the **2nd Five-Year Plan** (P.C. Mahalanobis model) and the **1966** plan period; the focus crop was **wheat**.
- **VoLTE** (Voice over LTE) network technology functions on **4G**.

9. World Circular Economy Forum (WCEF)

- **Circular economy:** reusing a product (e.g., reselling a used phone in the second-hand market) instead of discarding it — keeping resources in a continuous "circle" of use.
- 2026 edition venue: **Mahatma Mandir Convention Centre, Gandhinagar, Gujarat** (Gandhinagar is Amit Shah's parliamentary constituency).
- Dates: **15–16 September 2026** — first time the forum is hosted in **Asia**, and specifically in **India**.
- This is the **10th edition** of the forum.
- Theme: "*Circular Economy Transition for People and Prosperity*."
- Origin: concept started in **Finland**, promoted by the **Sitra** (Finnish Innovation Fund).

10. Sports & Games Current Affairs

- **Khelo India Youth Games 2024:** held in Bihar. **Next edition:** Tamil Nadu.
- **Kho-Kho World Cup 2024:** hosted in India.
- Athlete banned for doping (2024): **DP Manu**.

11. Samvatsari Parv (Jainism – Paryushan Parva)

- Founder of Jainism: **Mahavir Swami**; symbol: the **Lion**. Tirthankaras = spiritual teachers; the **first Tirthankara** was **Rishabhdev**.
- Two sects: **Shwetambar** (wear white clothes, follow "Agam" teachings of Mahavir, allow women to attain enlightenment, practise idol worship) and **Digambar** (do not wear clothes, no idol worship).
- **Samvatsari Parv** is the **last (8th) day** of the Paryushan festival — observed by the Shwetambar sect.
- Devotees seek forgiveness from God for their sins; key term: "**Micchami Dukkadam**" — forgiving others for any wrong done to oneself.
- Observed on **15 September 2026** this year.

- Related term: **Sallekhana** — a Jain practice of gradually giving up food/water to attain moksha (not to be confused with Buddhist practices).

12. World Ozone Day

- Observed every year on **16 September** — the day the **Montreal Protocol** was signed, in **1987**.
- This year's focus: the **Kigali Protocol**, which calls for reducing **HFCs (Hydrofluorocarbons)**, used in ACs and refrigerators.
- World Ozone Day first observed in **2009**.
- Ozone was first identified by French scientists **Charles Fabry** and **Henri Buisson**.
- The ozone layer lies in the **Stratosphere** and absorbs harmful **UV rays**.
- 2026 theme: "*Global Action for a Cooler Planet – Protect the Ozone Layer, Protect our Future Planet*" (key words: Ozone Layer, Planet's Future).
- **Kigali Protocol** (2019): aims to keep the rise in Earth's temperature under control (target ~0.4°C). Kigali is the capital of **Rwanda** (Africa).

13. National Engineers Day (India)

- Observed on **15 September** — birthday of **Sir M. Visvesvaraya**.
- Belonged to Mysuru, Karnataka; completed his education in Chennai.
- Built the **Krishna Raja Sagar Dam** on the **Kaveri River**, Karnataka; planned the **Osman Sagar** and **Himayat Sagar** reservoirs.
- Known as the "**Father of Modern Mysore**"; also served as **Diwan of Mysore**.
- Authored the book "*Planning Economy for India*."
- Awarded the **Bharat Ratna** in **1955**.

14. India's Artificial-Sun Experiment (SST-1 Tokamak)

- Being developed by the **Institute for Plasma Research, Gujarat**, using **nuclear fusion** technology (the process that powers the Sun).
- Purpose: to generate extremely high heat energy comparable to the Sun's core temperature, so future high-heat research/missions can be trial-tested on Earth (officially NOT described as building a literal artificial sun).
- China's equivalent artificial-sun project is called **EAST**.
- **SST-1 = Steady State Superconducting Tokamak**.
- Power capacity of the Gyrotron installed: **400 kW**.
- Achieved temperature: about **20 times** the temperature of the Sun's core.
- A **Gyrotron** is a device that produces microwave energy at high frequency, used to generate the heat.

15–17. More Current Affairs

- **New frog species** discovered near **Aizawl** (Mizoram University campus, on the banks of the Tlawng river) by **Mizoram University**; named "**Ingerana**." First such species found in India; not yet listed in the IUCN database; found in freshwater/forest habitats.
- **Global Chess League 2026** (4th edition) held in **Bengaluru**: **Ganges Grandmasters** won the title for the **first time**, defeating **Alpine Warriors** in the final. Alpine's roster included **Magnus Carlsen** (Norway, World No. 1), **Divya Deshmukh** (India, GM) and **Koneru Humpy** (Andhra Pradesh, GM). India currently has **99 Grandmasters**; the latest is **V.S. Rathanvel**. Winner and runner-up teams received prize money as announced by the league.
- **Saudi Arabia** shut down its **East-West Pipeline** (run by **Aramco**) following drone attacks near Riyadh and Madina. The pipeline (~1,200 km) links the **Yanbu Port** (Red Sea) to the **Abqaiq oil field**, extending toward the **Strait of Hormuz/Iran**, and carries about **4%** of the world's oil & gas supply.

Quick Revision (Homework Recap)

- **SEMICON India 2026**: 17–19 September, New Delhi.
- PM Modi's festival greeting: for a festival in **Israel**.
- First Indian male recurve archer to win a World Cup: **Dhiraj**.
- Guinness World Record: India's **Slag Road** (1+ km), Chhattisgarh.
- **Upper Bhadra Project**: water reached a region after 50 years — in **Karnataka**.
- **Colombo Security Conclave**: recently hosted, organised by the **Eastern Naval Command**.
- Bengaluru-based company awarded a US patent: **GalaxEye**.
- **6th All India Conference on Official Language**: held in Mumbai, hosted by **Amit Shah**.
- **Asia Cup**: India won by **72 runs**, defeating **Sri Lanka**.

Practice MCQs – Current Affairs

Q1. Which three nations' leaders signed an agreement to seek separation from England?

- Scotland, Wales & Northern Ireland
- Scotland, France & Wales
- Wales, Ireland & Iceland
- England, Scotland & Ireland

Answer: A — Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland.

Q2. The Act of Union (1707) combined which three to form Great Britain?

- England, Wales, Northern Ireland
- England, Wales, Scotland
- Scotland, Ireland, Wales
- England, Ireland, Scotland

Answer: B — England, Wales and Scotland.

Q3. What is the capital of Wales?

- Belfast
- Edinburgh
- Cardiff
- Dublin

Answer: C — Cardiff.

Q4. Nuakhai Juhar is mainly a festival of which region?

- A. Western Odisha
- B. Western Australia
- C. Western Bengal
- D. Western Assam

Answer: A — Western Odisha (also Chhattisgarh & Jharkhand).

Q5. Who started the tradition of Nuakhai Juhar in the 12th century?

- A. Raja Ramai Deo
- B. Raja Man Singh
- C. Raja Bhoj
- D. Raja Krishnadevaraya

Answer: A — Raja Ramai Deo.

Q6. India's backwaters (Kayals) are primarily found in which state?

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Kerala
- C. Karnataka
- D. Goa

Answer: B — Kerala.

Q7. HPV stands for:

- A. Human Papilloma Virus
- B. Human Pathogenic Virus
- C. Human Protein Virus
- D. Hepatic Papilloma Virus

Answer: A — Human Papilloma Virus.

Q8. HPV vaccination in India targets which age group of girls?

- A. 5–8 years
- B. 9–14 years
- C. 15–18 years
- D. 20–25 years

Answer: B — 9–14 years.

Q9. Which state achieved 100% HPV vaccination coverage and ranked No. 1?

- A. Uttar Pradesh
- B. Madhya Pradesh
- C. Gujarat
- D. Mizoram

Answer: C — Gujarat.

Q10. NASA's RECY mission is associated with the study of:

- A. Solar flares
- B. Black holes
- C. Lunar craters
- D. Mars atmosphere

Answer: A — Solar flares.

Q11. The 2026 World Circular Economy Forum is being held in:

- A. Helsinki, Finland
- B. Gandhinagar, Gujarat
- C. New Delhi
- D. Kigali, Rwanda

Answer: B — Gandhinagar, Gujarat (Mahatma Mandir Convention Centre).

Q12. The Circular Economy concept originated with which fund/country?

- A. Sitra, Finland
- B. UNDP, USA
- C. NITI Aayog, India
- D. WWF, Switzerland

Answer: A — Sitra (Finnish Innovation Fund), Finland.

Q13. Khelo India Youth Games 2024 was held in:

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Bihar
- C. Gujarat
- D. Odisha

Answer: B — Bihar.

Q14. Samvatsari Parv marks the last day of which festival?

- A. Paryushan Parva
- B. Diwali
- C. Navratri
- D. Onam

Answer: A — Paryushan Parva (Jainism, Shwetambar sect).

Q15. Which term means seeking/giving forgiveness during Samvatsari Parv?

- A. Micchami Dukkadam
- B. Namokar Mantra
- C. Ahimsa Vrat
- D. Kshama Yatra

Answer: A — Micchami Dukkadam.

Q16. World Ozone Day is observed every year on:

- A. 5 June
- B. 16 September
- C. 22 April
- D. 11 December

Answer: B — 16 September (Montreal Protocol signed 1987).

Q17. The Kigali Protocol primarily aims to reduce the use of:

- A. CFCs
- B. HFCs (Hydrofluorocarbons)
- C. CO₂ only
- D. Methane only

Answer: B — HFCs (Hydrofluorocarbons).

Q18. National Engineers Day in India is observed on the birthday of:

- A. Sir M. Visvesvaraya
- B. C.V. Raman
- C. Homi Bhabha
- D. APJ Abdul Kalam

Answer: A — Sir M. Visvesvaraya (15 September).

Q19. SST-1, India's fusion research device, stands for:

- A. Steady State Superconducting Tokamak
- B. Solar Sun Testing-1
- C. Solid State Super Turbine
- D. Space Station Tokamak-1

Answer: A — Steady State Superconducting Tokamak.

Q20. China's artificial-sun (fusion) project is known as:

- A. EAST
- B. WEST
- C. SUNRISE
- D. NOVA

Answer: A — EAST.

Q21. The new frog species "Ingerana" was recently discovered in:

- A. Mizoram
- B. Meghalaya
- C. Assam
- D. Manipur

Answer: A — Mizoram (Aizawl, on the Tlawng river).

Q22. Global Chess League 2026 (4th edition) was won for the first time by:

- A. Alpine Warriors
- B. Ganges Grandmasters
- C. Mumba Masters
- D. Triveni Continental Kings

Answer: B — Ganges Grandmasters (final held in Bengaluru).

Q23. Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline, recently shut due to drone attacks, is operated by:

- A. Aramco
- B. ONGC
- C. ADNOC
- D. BP

Answer: A — Aramco.

Q24. India's recent Asia Cup win was against which team, and by what margin?

- A. Pakistan, by 45 runs
- B. Sri Lanka, by 72 runs
- C. Bangladesh, by 10 wickets
- D. Afghanistan, by 55 runs

Answer: B — Sri Lanka, by 72 runs.